2025年8月2日大陆雅思纸笔考试听力(机经原题)

Part 4

Part 4, you will hear a woman talking on their expedition to the lost city of Tecora. First you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

Good morning, everyone. Today's lecture will take us on a journey to one of archaeology's greatest mysteries - the lost city of Tecora. As many of you know, I've just returned from leading a three-month expedition to this remarkable site, and I'm excited to share our findings with you today.

First, let's establish some historical context. Tecora flourished between the 9th and 12th centuries AD as the capital of the ancient Molan civilization. Contemporary accounts describe it as "a city of unimaginable wealth," which brings me to my first point. Many people come to this city to search for huge treasure (31) underwater - not just gold and jewels, but also priceless cultural artifacts. This reputation has, unfortunately, made it a prime target for looters in modern times.

The city's geographical location presents unique challenges for researchers. Situated in what is now northern Guatemala, Tecora was deliberately built in the heart of an extremely dense jungle (32). This tropical rainforest environment has both preserved and concealed the ruins for centuries.

Our team discovered that the Molan people had an extraordinary connection with nature. This is most evident in their architecture, particularly the numerous sculptures of animals (33) that decorate every major structure. From jaguars to exotic birds, these artworks provide invaluable insights into their ecosystem and belief systems.

The city's layout reveals sophisticated urban planning. Located within a naturally protected valley (34), Tecora's location was carefully selected by its legendary king (35), Molan Tec. Historical records suggest he established this settlement after years of searching for the perfect defensive position.

What's fascinating is how the Molan adapted to their environment. While the place provided protection from invaders, it also created microclimates that supported advanced agriculture. Our soil analysis shows they developed irrigation systems far ahead of their time.

Now, let's examine Tecora's mysterious decline. Contrary to popular theories about warfare, our findings point to the insects and disease (36) as the primary causes.

Recent excavations uncovered mass graves containing victims of what appears to be multiple epidemics. Our pathologists identified several mosquito-borne illnesses, along with water contamination from poor waste management.

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Transitioning to contemporary issues, accessing Tecora remains enormously difficult. The only practical method is by helicopter (37), as the surrounding area is virtually impassable by foot. However, the expense (38) is astronomical - each hour of flight time costs approximately $5,000 when you factor in fuel, maintenance, and insurance.

The construction methods used in Tecora present additional complications. Unlike contemporaneous cities that used stone, Tecora's buildings were primarily made from earth (39) - a compressed mixture of local clay and river sand. As a result, the structure isn't particularly durable. While innovative for its time, this makes preservation extremely challenging.

In recent years, the Guatemalan government has implemented rigorous protection (40) measures. A 50-kilometer exclusion zone has been established, patrolled by both local authorities and international heritage organizations.

There's been considerable debate about opening the site to controlled tourism, which could generate significant profit. However, after careful consideration, the preservation committee has maintained its focus on protection rather than commercialization.

That’s the end of Part 4. You now have half a minute to check your answers.

2025年5月24日大陆雅思纸笔考试听力(机经原题)

Part 4

You will hear a part of a lecture about the evolution and cultivation of vegetables. First, you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

Good afternoon everyone. Today's lecture focuses on the evolution and cultivation of vegetables, particularly examining modern agricultural challenges and experimental approaches. Over times, humans have transformed wild plants into staple crops, but this progress hasn't been without hurdles. Our discussion draws from a decade-long project. The **Backlog Vegetable Study**. To address food shortages, the (31) **government** offered funds to this research. Now, let's uncover how ancient practices intersect with cutting-edge research.

For centuries, farmers who mainly grow vegetables have relied on two foundational practices: **cultivating the earth** to prepare seedbeds and **fertilizing the fields** to replenish nutrients. While these methods seem straightforward, recent studies reveal unintended consequences. Now let's look at the theories behind these consequences. Aggressive farming doesn't just deplete resources—it alters landscapes. Farming practices, say, repetitive tilling, which is a common cultivation strategy, will disturb dormant seeds from a variety of plants buried deep in the soil. Therefore, this practice leads to **the growth of (32) weeds over time, instead of eliminating them,** compared to no-till farming.

This brings us to the second **theory** behind modern agriculture. Intensive **farming practices** may boost short-term yields but harm the land. One critical issue is soil degradation. Over-farming strips away organic matter, destroying soil (**33)** **structure** that allows root system to breathe. Think of soil as a layered cake: crush it flat, and nothing grows well. **Or i**magine crushing a sponge until it loses its shape. To make matters worse, compaction forced farmers to irrigate more frequently. Much more (**34)** **water** is needed by crops in degraded soil during growth phases.

To address these challenges, researchers designed a controlled experiment comparing traditional and modern plots. **Plot A** uses conventional methods, where composted vegetables are processed using (**35)** **machine**—tractors and tillers dominate the workflow. The focus here is purely on **the composition of the earth**, prioritizing nutrient levels over ecosystem balance.

In contrast, **Plot B, which uses experimental approaches,** adopts mixed cropping strategies. It was tested which season is ideal for mixed cropping. Initially, trials in winter showed poor germination due to frost, but adjustments were made. Researchers experimented with plants like beans and squash, observing mutual benefits in pest control. Eventually, researchers concluded that the **best period for mixed cropping** occurs (**36) during spring**, when soil temperatures and moisture levels create ideal growing conditions.

Of course, seasonal changes alone don't guarantee success. To isolate variables, the team had to standardize several **control factors***. First, the research team must make sure that all plots shared a* (**37) history alike***, including identical crop rotations, fallow periods, and fertilizer use, for five years prior. This eliminated differences in soil quality. Researchers also ensured uniform conditions—like rainfall.* Additionally, **dense planting arrangements** were standardized. By spacing rows precisely, every plant received equal (**38)** **sunlight**, no overshadowing by taller crops. This careful planning not only optimized above-ground growth but also raised questions about what was happening below the soil. Researchers wondered—if arrangement above ground can be controlled so precisely, could the same principles apply to deeper soil layers?

To answer the question, the experiment of next phase targets (**39**) **root** vegetables like carrots and potatoes. Organic variants will be prioritized to test resilience in low-fertilizer environments. Future studies aim to measure not just crop quantities but also sensory qualities. Starting next year, labs will analyze the (**40**) **taste** profiles of harvested plants—sweetness in tomatoes, bitterness in greens—to assess nutritional impacts.

That is the end of Part 4. You now have half a minute to check your answers.

2025年5月17日大陆雅思纸笔考试听力（机经原题）

Part 4

You will hear a part of a lecture about a creature called water mouse. First, you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

Today, we'll examine how the water mouse serves as a critical bioindicator species for freshwater environments. First, some background information. Why do the scientists carry out research on water mice? These creatures are sensitive to pollutants, particularly heavy metals like mercury, so they can be a kind of early warning system for ecological degradation. Through longitudinal studies, ecologists have demonstrated that monitoring these rodents provides a reliable measure of the **(31)** **health** of river ecosystems.

Now, regarding habitat preferences: water mice avoid fast-flowing currents, favouring calm bodies of water. While they're most abundant in slow-moving rivers, significant populations also thrive in (**32**) **lakes** with minimal depth**,** especially those with floating vegetation like water lilies. These plants offer dual benefits: shelter from aerial predators and hunting grounds for aquatic insects.

Nest construction reveals fascinating adaptations. Using reeds and grasses, they build waterproof chambers beside banks, always embedding them in (**33**) **mud** or beneath vegetation clusters. This design maintains stable humidity levels critical for juvenile survival. Field identification is simplified by their unique markings – irregular white **(34)** **spots** on their compact grey bodies, a pattern absent in similar wetland rodents.

To study their ecological impact without direct observation, researchers employ indirect methods. By measuring nitrogen isotopes in the **（35）** **soil** surrounding burrows, which serve as an indicator of sufficiency of nutrients, scientists learned about the feeding habits of water mice.

While natural predators exist, not all pose equal threats. Cats occasionally prey on mice near human settlements, but camera trap data shows this accounts for less than 5% of mortality. The primary danger comes from **(36)** **foxes**, whose acute sense of smell allows them to locate nests even during flood events. To study predation patterns, scientists deploy a well-designed non-lethal **(37)** **trap** equipped with infrared sensors. These devices immobilise animals temporarily using air-pressure cushions – a method praised for its zero-injury rate. All captured specimens are released within 200 meters of their capture site to minimise disorientation.

Recent advances combine ecology with forensic science. Motion-activated cameras now collect shed **(38)** **hair** from grooming sites, which DNA analysis links to individual mice. This replaces invasive ear-tagging and allows tracking lifespan data – some individuals have been recorded surviving over 3 years, exceptional for small rodents.

Habitat fragmentation remains a key challenge. Current efforts involve synthesising satellite imagery with field data to draw a dynamic **(39)** **map** of core habitats. This GIS-based tool highlights zones where logging runoff overlaps with high mouse density, guiding targeted reforestation.

Community engagement has proven equally vital. Pilot programmes educating **(40)** **farmers** on integrated pest management allowed a 42% drop in the use of pesticide in participating watersheds. Remarkably, mouse populations in these areas showed a 17% rebound within two breeding cycles – clear evidence of policy efficacy.

That is the end of Part 4. You now have half a minute to check your answers.